

Tuesday, August 2

Today went smoothly. Everyone has adjusted to the new schedule. Matthew woke at 6:45 and slept with me in the living room the next half-hour. Peter spent one hour in a large group learning new techniques, and one hour in a master class. The only hint of his not being overjoyed came during the last hour.

He leaned to Cheryl and asked, "Mom, are my holidays over?"

"Not really Peter."

"Then why am I playing my cello?" He spent the rest of the evening humming his pieces. He passed on this bit of confidence: "Mom I got confused and I'd try. I'd get confused again and I'd try."

Cheryl joined the other parents at a special session from 4 - 5. Matthew and I strolled around the campus, and watched the security ticketing all the cars, no matter if they were out of province. Matthew beat his arms to the time of a water sprinkler. He pushed his stroller in the hallways. He briefly sleeps now and then, but is more interested in watching children throwing paper planes from the 2nd floor, studying the wall and floor patterns, turning radiator knobs, following a dragonfly as it beat itself against the inside of a window, and listening to the music. We returned to the apartment at noon hoping that Peter might sleep. He lay awake for an hour on the waterbed, but the apartment is hot, and everyone sweats.

Michael had a game at 6:30. We ate pancakes before he went. We drove to the Chinook Mall on McLeod Trail, then to the waterslides on McLeod and Heritage Drive. It's a relief to feel moving air. The waterslides are \$8 for the day. We'll go maybe tomorrow. Peter used \$10 given to him from Papa in two toy stores. He liked a gun with ricochet sound effects, but looked around. He thought that nothing else seemed as good, but would wait to buy it tomorrow. Michael and Cathy were home when we returned. They had won their game 28 - 7. Michael is the captain. We talked, then read some old letters. Cheryl learned family things by reading mom's letters to Michael. We talked about family members. Michael feels separated from the rest of his brothers and sisters, removed from the heat

of things, the controversy that set the tone of our youth. The plan for tomorrow after supper is for Peter to see "Snow White" with Michael and Cathy.